Bank Reconciliation System — User Manual

Q-SOFT SOLUTIONS LIMITED | Ghana
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1. Introduction

The Bank Reconciliation System (BRS) is a web-based SaaS application designed for accounting firms and businesses in Ghana. It helps you:

- Upload cash books and bank statements (Excel, CSV, PDF, images)
- Map columns to the correct fields
- Reconcile receipts vs credits and payments vs debits with intelligent matching
- Generate professional Bank Reconciliation Statements (BRS) with your branding
- Export reports as PDF or Excel

The system supports multiple Ghanaian banks with auto-detection of statement formats and offers flexible matching (1-to-1, 1-to-many, many-to-1, many-to-many).

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2. Features List

Core Features (All Plans)

Feature	Description
Document upload	Upload cash book and bank statement in Excel (.xlsx), CSV, PDF, or images (PNG, JPG, TIFF)
Multi-bank support	One project can have multiple bank accounts; filter by account during reconcile and report
Column mapping	Map your document columns to date, amount, description, reference, cheque number
1-to-1 matching	Match a single cash book line to a single bank line
Side-by-side view	View receipts vs credits and payments vs debits in a clear layout
Report generation	Generate BRS with closing balance, uncredited lodgments, unpresented cheques

Export	Export report as PDF or Excel
Clients	Link projects to clients for organisation
Currency	Support for GHS, USD, EUR per project

Standard Plan and Above

Feature	Description
Bank rules	Create custom rules (e.g. if description contains X → suggest match)
Bulk match	Match up to 50 transactions at once
AI suggestions	Suggested matches based on amount, date, and reference
Audit trail	View action history (who did what, when)
Discrepancy report	Identify variances and exceptions
Missing cheques report	Track unpresented cheques

Premium Plan and Above

Feature	Description
1-to-many / many-to-many	Match one cash book line to multiple bank lines (or vice versa)
Roll-forward	Carry unpresented cheques to the next period
Threshold approval	Set an approval threshold amount (e.g. above GH₵10,000 needs reviewer)
Full branding	Logo, primary/secondary colours, letterhead, report title, footer

Firm Plan

Feature	Description
API access	Create API keys for programmatic access
Multi-client dashboard	Manage multiple client organisations
Unlimited	Unlimited projects and transactions

Ghana Bank Support

Bank	Auto-detection
Ecobank Ghana	✓
GCB Bank	✓
Access Bank Ghana	✓
Stanbic Bank Ghana	✓
Fidelity Bank Ghana	✓
UBA Ghana	✓
Absa Ghana	✓

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3. Getting Started

Accessing the System

1. Open your web browser and go to the application URL (e.g. `https://app.yourdomain.com`).
2. If you do not have an account, click **Register**.
3. If you have an account, enter your email and password and click **Login**.

First-Time Setup

1. **Register** — Create an account with your email, password, name, and organisation name.
2. **Verify your email** — If required, follow the verification link sent to your email.
3. **Sign in** — You will be taken to the Dashboard.

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4. Account Management

Registration

1. Go to the **Register** page.
2. Enter:
   - **Email** — Your email address
   - **Password** — At least 8 characters (recommended: mix of letters, numbers, symbols)
   - **Name** — Your full name
   - **Organisation name** — Your company or firm name
3. Click **Register**.
4. You will be created as an organisation admin and can invite other members.

Login

1. Go to the **Login** page.
2. Enter your **email** and **password**.
3. Click **Login**.
4. You will be redirected to the Dashboard.

Forgot Password

1. Click **Forgot password** on the login page.
2. Enter your email address.
3. Click **Send reset link**.
4. Check your email for a reset link (ensure `RESEND_API_KEY` is configured for production).
5. Click the link and set a new password.

Logout

Click your profile/name in the top-right corner and select **Logout**.

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5. Dashboard

The Dashboard gives you an overview of your organisation.

What You See

- **Usage metrics** — Number of projects and transactions used this month vs your plan limit
- **Recent projects** — Quick links to your latest projects
- **Quick actions** — Links to create a new project, view reports, or go to settings

Navigation

Use the main navigation menu:

- **Dashboard** — Home
- **Projects** — List and manage projects
- **Reports** — Completed projects (ready for export)
- **Clients** — Manage clients
- **Audit** — Action history (Standard plan and above)
- **Settings** — Branding, billing, members, API keys, bank rules

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6. Projects

Creating a Project

1. Go to **Projects** → **New project**.
2. Enter:
    - **Name** — e.g. "Ecobank Jan 2025"
    - **Client** (optional) — Select from your clients or leave blank
    - **Currency** — GHS (default), USD, or EUR
    - **Roll-forward from** (optional) — Select a completed project to carry unpresented cheques forward (Premium+)
3. Click **Create**.

Project List

- View all projects with status: **Draft**, **Reconciling**, **In review**, **Completed**.
- Filter by status using the filter dropdown.
- Click a project to open it and start the reconciliation workflow.

Editing a Project

1. Open the project.
2. Click **Edit** next to the project name.
3. Change name, client, or currency.
4. Click **Save**.

Deleting a Project

- Only **Admin** can delete a project.
- Click **Delete** and confirm. This removes the project and all related data.

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7. Reconciliation Workflow (5 Steps)

Each project follows a 5-step workflow. Use the step tabs at the top: **Upload** → **Map** → **Reconcile** → **Review** → **Report**.

Step 1: Upload

Upload your cash book and bank statement.

Cash Book

- **Receipts** — Money received (income)
- **Payments** — Money paid out (expenses)
- **Both** — If one file contains both, select "Both" and upload once

Supported formats: Excel (.xlsx), CSV, PDF, images (PNG, JPG, TIFF).

Bank Statement

- **Credits** — Money credited to your account
- **Debits** — Money debited from your account
- **Both** — If one file contains both, select "Both" and upload once

Multiple bank accounts: If you have more than one account, add or select a bank account name before uploading.

Tips

- Use Excel or CSV for best parsing results.
- Ghana bank formats (Ecobank, GCB, Access, etc.) are auto-detected.
- Ensure dates and amounts are in clear columns.

Step 2: Map

If any document has unmapped columns, the Map step will show them.

1. For each document (cash book receipts, payments, bank credits, debits):
    - Select which column maps to **Date**
    - Select which column maps to **Amount** (received/paid or credit/debit)
    - Select which column maps to **Description** (or Particulars, Narrative)
    - Optionally map **Reference** and **Cheque number**
2. Click **Save mapping**.
3. Proceed to **Reconcile**.

Step 3: Reconcile

Match cash book lines to bank lines.

Receipts vs Credits

- **Receipts** — Money you recorded as received (cash book)
- **Credits** — Money the bank has credited to your account

Match each receipt to its corresponding bank credit (or leave unmatched if it is an uncredited lodgment).

Payments vs Debits

- **Payments** — Money you recorded as paid (e.g. cheques issued)
- **Debits** — Money the bank has debited from your account

Match each payment to its corresponding bank debit (or leave unmatched if it is an unpresented cheque).

How to Match

1. **Single match:** Select one cash book line and one bank line, then click **Match**.
2. **Bulk match (Standard+):** Select multiple pairs (up to 50) and click **Bulk match**.
3. **1-to-many / many-to-many (Premium+):** Select one cash book line and multiple bank lines (or vice versa), then match.

Suggestions

- If your plan includes AI suggestions, suggested matches appear. Review and accept or ignore.
- Use **Bank rules** (Settings → Bank rules) to auto-suggest matches based on conditions.

Filters

- Filter by **bank account** if you have multiple.
- Filter by **amount** or **date** to find specific transactions.

Unmatched Items

- **Uncredited lodgments** — Receipts not yet credited by the bank. Leave unmatched; they appear on the BRS as additions.
- **Unpresented cheques** — Cheques issued but not yet presented. Leave unmatched; they appear on the BRS as deductions.

Step 4: Review

1. When reconciliation is complete, click **Submit for review** (if you have a reviewer).
2. The project status becomes **In review**.
3. A **Reviewer** or **Admin** can:
    - **Approve** — Mark as completed
    - **Send back** — Return to the preparer for changes

Step 5: Report

View and export the Bank Reconciliation Statement.

Report Contents

- **Closing balance per bank statement**
- **Add: Uncredited lodgments** — Table with date, details, amount
- **Less: Unpresented cheques** — Table with date, details, cheque number, amount
- **Balance per cash book at end of period**

Actions

- **Edit summary & notes** — Add narrative, preparer comment, reviewer comment
- **Add supporting documents** — Attach approval scans, extra PDFs (not parsed for transactions)
- **Export PDF** — Download the BRS as PDF
- **Export Excel** — Download as Excel
- **Print** — Print the report
- **Approve** (Reviewer/Admin) — Mark project as completed
- **Reopen** (Reviewer/Admin) — Return to Reconcile for changes
- **Roll-forward** (Premium+) — Create a new project with unpresented cheques carried forward

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8. Clients

Manage clients to organise projects.

Adding a Client

1. Go to **Clients**.
2. Click **Add client**.
3. Enter the client name (max 200 characters).
4. Click **Save**.

Using Clients

- When creating or editing a project, select a client from the dropdown.
- Clients help you filter and organise projects by client.

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9. Settings

Access **Settings** from the main menu. Tabs: **Branding**, **Billing**, **Members**, **API keys**, **Bank rules**.

Branding (Admin only)

- **Logo** — Upload your organisation logo (PNG or JPEG)
- **Primary colour** — Main colour for buttons and accents
- **Secondary colour** — Secondary accent
- **Letterhead address** — Address shown on reports
- **Report title** — Default "Bank Reconciliation Statement" or custom
- **Footer** — Text at bottom of reports
- **Approval threshold** (Premium+) — Amount above which reviewer approval is required

Click **Reset to platform default** to restore platform defaults.

Billing (Admin only)

- View **current plan** and usage (projects, transactions)
- **Upgrade** — Click to pay via Paystack (GHS)
- **Intro offer** — 50% off first payment when enabled by platform

Members (Admin only)

- **Add member** — Enter email and assign role (Admin, Reviewer, Preparer, Viewer)
- **Change role** — Edit existing members
- **Remove member** — Remove from organisation

API Keys (Firm plan, Admin only)

- **Create API key** — Generate a key for programmatic access
- **Revoke** — Delete a key when no longer needed

Bank Rules (Admin/Reviewer)

Create rules to auto-suggest matches:

1. **Condition** — e.g. "Description contains" → "SALARY"
2. **Action** — e.g. "Suggest match" or "Flag for review"
3. **Priority** — Higher priority rules run first

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10. Audit Log

(Standard plan and above)

- View **Audit** to see who did what and when.
- Actions logged: login, project create/edit/delete, upload, match, submit, approve, reopen, etc.
- Export audit log if your plan supports it.

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11. Reports

- **Reports** in the menu shows projects with status **Completed**.
- Click a project to open its Report step and export PDF or Excel.

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12. Subscription Plans & Limits

Plan	Projects/mo	Transactions/mo	Users
Basic	5	500	1
Standard	20	2,000	3
Premium	100	10,000	5+
Firm	Unlimited	Unlimited	Unlimited

- **Intro offer:** 50% off first payment when enabled.
- **Yearly billing:** ~17% discount vs monthly.

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13. Supported Banks

The system auto-detects these Ghanaian bank statement formats:

Bank	Detection

Ecobank Ghana	Headers + description content
GCB Bank	Value Date, Particulars, Credit/Debit
Access Bank Ghana	Header contains "access"
Stanbic Bank Ghana	Header or content contains "stanbic"
Fidelity Bank Ghana	Header or content contains "fidelity"
UBA Ghana	Header or content contains "uba"
Absa Ghana	Header or content contains "absa" or "barclays"

If your bank is not auto-detected, use the **Map** step to manually map columns.

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14. Roles & Permissions

Action	Admin	Reviewer	Preparer	Viewer
Delete project	✓			
Reopen project	✓	✓		
Edit bank rules	✓	✓		
Edit branding	✓			
Manage billing	✓			
Manage members	✓			
Export report	✓	✓	✓	
Create project	✓	✓	✓	
Upload documents	✓	✓	✓	
Map documents	✓	✓	✓	
Reconcile	✓	✓	✓	
Submit for review	✓	✓	✓	
Approve	✓	✓		
Delete attachment	✓	✓		

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15. Troubleshooting

Issue	Solution
Cannot log in / 401	Check API is running; ensure `VITE_API_URL` points to the API
Upload fails	Use Excel or CSV for testing; ensure file is not corrupted
Parse errors	Check column headers; use Map step to correct mapping
No suggested matches	Ensure you have Standard plan or above; check bank rules
Export fails	For large reports (200+ transactions), wait 30–60 seconds

CORS errors	Ensure frontend URL is in `CORS_ORIGIN` (production)
Password reset not received	Configure `RESEND_API_KEY` and `APP_URL` in production

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16. Glossary

Term	Meaning
Cash book	Your organisation's record of receipts and payments
Bank statement	The bank's record of credits and debits to your account
Receipts	Money received (cash book)
Payments	Money paid out (cash book)
Credits	Money credited to your account (bank)
Debits	Money debited from your account (bank)
Uncredited lodgments	Receipts you recorded but not yet credited by the bank
Unpresented cheques	Cheques you issued but not yet presented to the bank
Balance per cash book	Reconciled balance = bank closing + lodgments – unpresented cheques
BRS	Bank Reconciliation Statement
Roll-forward	Carry unpresented cheques to the next period

End of User Manual